ERA 4

The Seven Years' War

1754 – 1763

The French & Indian War · British policy after the war

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did victory in the French & Indian War plant the seeds of the American Revolution?

KEY TERMS

French & Indian War · Albany Plan of Union · Treaty of Paris (1763) · Pontiac's Rebellion · Proclamation of 1763

ALIGNED TO

CED Topics 3.1–3.2 · AMSCO Ch. 3.1–3.2

CAUSES OF THE WAR

A Clash of Empires

The French & Indian War



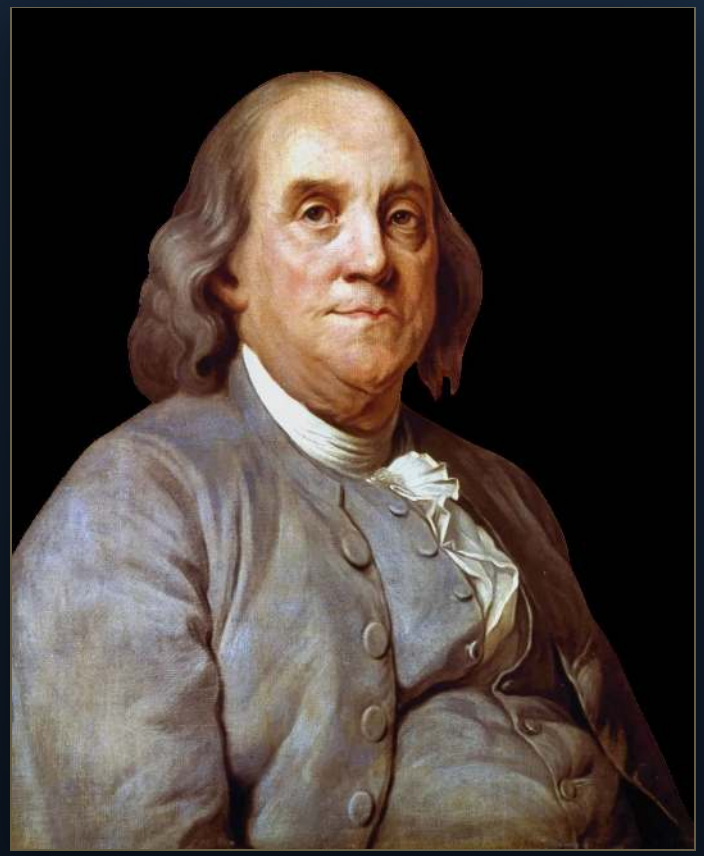
- Britain and France fought for control of the **Ohio Valley** (1754–1763).
- France, its colonists, and most Native nations faced Britain and its colonists.
- It was the North American front of a wider global war.

Washington's First Command

- Virginia sent a young colonel—**George Washington**—to challenge the French.
- He was defeated at **Fort Necessity** in 1754.
- That skirmish sparked the French & Indian War.



The Albany Plan of Union



- **Benjamin Franklin** proposed the **Albany Plan of Union** to coordinate colonial defense.
- It called for an intercolonial government—an early vision of unity.
- The colonies rejected it, but the idea outlived the war.

SECTION

The War & Its End

Turning the Tide

1754
Fort Necessity
Washington's defeat opens the war.

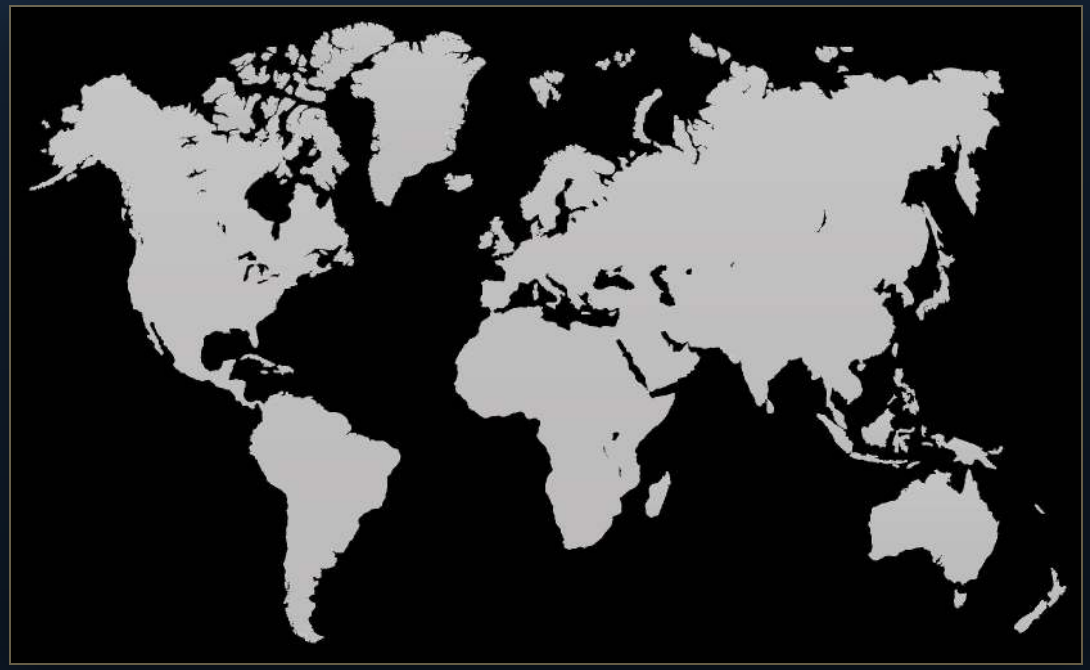
1755
Braddock's Defeat
Early British losses in the wilderness.

1759
Fall of Quebec
Britain seizes the initiative.

1763
Treaty of Paris
France is driven from mainland North America.

The Treaty of Paris, 1763

- France lost virtually all its mainland North American territory.
- Britain gained **Canada** and land east of the Mississippi.
- Britain now reigned supreme in North America—at enormous cost.



WHY VICTORY BACKFIRED

The Road to Revolution

Victory Sows Division

COST

A Doubled Debt

The war doubled Britain's national debt.

→

POLICY

End of Salutary Neglect

Britain moves to tax the colonies to pay for it.

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FRICTION

Mutual Resentment

Britain and colonists each doubt the other's competence.

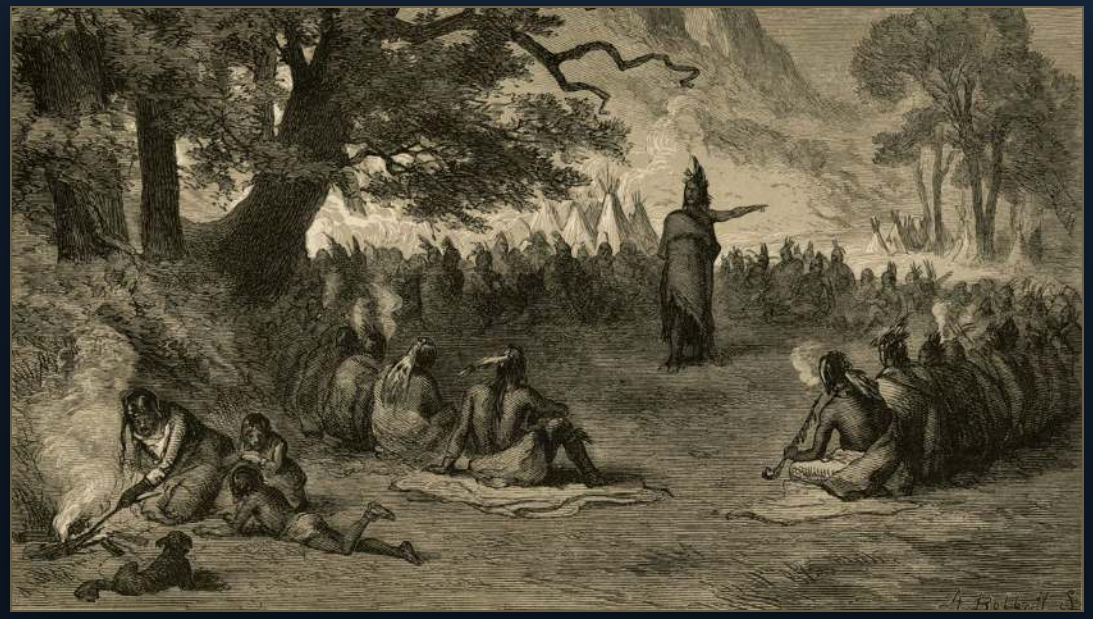
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RESULT

Rising Anger

New taxes and controls push colonists toward revolt.

Pontiac's Rebellion



- Native nations under **Pontiac** struck back against westward settlement.
- They destroyed forts and settlements across the frontier.
- Britain sent regular troops—an expensive new burden.

The Proclamation of 1763

- To calm the frontier, Britain barred settlement west of the **Appalachians**.
- Colonists—eager for western land—were furious.
- Thousands simply ignored the **Proclamation of 1763**.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Seven Years' War

1. Rivalry over the **Ohio Valley** ignited the French & Indian War; the **Albany Plan of Union** was an early (failed) bid for colonial unity.

2. Britain's total victory (**Treaty of Paris, 1763**) ended French power but **doubled its debt**—ending **salutary neglect**.

3. **Pontiac's Rebellion** and the **Proclamation of 1763** angered colonists and set the stage for revolution.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Seven Years' War

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Trace the chain from British **war debt** to the end of salutary neglect and new colonial taxes.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the colonists' relationship with Britain **change** from the start of the war to the Proclamation of 1763?

ARGUMENTATION

Make a claim: what was the single most important reason victory drove Britain and the colonies apart? Support it with **two pieces of evidence** from today.

Up next — **Lesson 6: Taxation Without Representation** (the road to revolution)